



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*sa tadannaṃ samānītaṃ samālabhya mahātapāḥ |
cukopa kupitaścāha pārthivaṃ pradahanniva || 22 ||
pārthivādhama viprāṇāṃ bhojanaṃ rākṣasocitaṃ |
na dīyate vidhijñena tvaṃ tu māmavamanyase || 23 ||
yasmāttvaṃ rākṣasamidaṃ mahyaṃ ditsasi bhojanam |
tasmāttvaṃ karmaṇā tena puruṣādo bhaviṣyasi || 24 ||*

— Skandapurāṇa, Chapter 17, Verses 22-24

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The Skandapurāṇa passage reveals a powerful sage, deeply angered by the food he is offered. This great ascetic, a master of spiritual practice, receives food that he deems unfit for a Brahmin, declaring it "fit for demons." In his rage, fueled by what he perceives as disrespect and a violation of sacred custom, he curses the king who offered it, decreeing that he will become a man-eater. The intensity of the sage's reaction might seem extreme to you, but it underscores a vital spiritual principle: the importance of intention and purity in all offerings, especially those related to sustenance.

The food itself represents more than mere physical nourishment. It symbolizes the king's attitude towards the sage and, by extension, towards the divine. The offering, if impure or ill-intentioned, becomes a reflection of the king's own spiritual state. The sage's anger isn't simply about the quality of the food; it's about the king's lack of reverence and understanding of dharma. The curse, while severe, serves as a cosmic correction, a consequence of the king's actions.

How does this apply to your life? Consider the offerings you make, not just in a literal sense, but in every aspect of your interactions. Are your actions imbued with genuine care and respect, or are they tainted by selfishness or negligence? The food you prepare, the work you produce, the words you speak – all are offerings to the world. When you approach these with mindfulness and pure intention, you cultivate positive karma and contribute to a more harmonious reality. Conversely, actions born of greed, anger, or carelessness can have unforeseen and detrimental consequences, much like the king's seemingly small act of offering the wrong kind of food. Strive for purity in your thoughts, words and deeds, and you will nourish yourself and the world around you.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What "food" am I offering the world with my daily actions, and how can I ensure it is nourishing rather than detrimental?